

**T**he premier open-wheel all-electric racing championship, the FIA Formula E World Championship, came to India in February. There had been much hype around the race weekend, with over 20,000 people coming down to Hyderabad's street circuit to attend the race. With all the thrills from the track, we saw a ray of hope shining through.

It was coming from India's seemingly bright EV future. And when we landed in Hyderabad, we went around looking for answers as to what will India's EV future look like. We asked the experts from various teams about the future of EV technology and chatted with the attendees as well, getting their views on the topic of the adoption of electric vehicles in India, where ICE-powered cars have ruled the streets for years now.

Prefacing our coverage of the event, we wrote an article titled - India's EV future - where we discussed what will India's future look like, especially after the arrival of Formula E in India. In that article, the author wrote - "Just like it is the case with MotoGP and other races that make owning a toned down variant of that vehicle 'cool', Formula E has made EVs 'cool' since its inaugural season. If a bike manufacturer wins a MotoGP rider's or constructor's title, their lineup of motorcycles globally gets a boost; in the same way, if a Formula E team wins a driver's or a constructor's title, then their sales are very likely to go up. Each win with a newer generation car provides further push to their agenda." And this has proven to be true. The atmosphere and the



Formula E cars are at the pinnacle of EV technology, breaking barriers in every way

overall positive incline towards electric vehicles at the event proved that the arrival of a premier racing series like Formula E is definitely going to have a positive impact on the adoption of EVs in India.

With manufacturers like Mahindra and TCS Jaguar striking a chord with Indian audiences, the entire atmosphere around the circuit echoed with chants praising the cars and the drivers alike. Other teams and the governing body of this championship, the FIA, did not leave any chance to ensure that the attendees got the full taste of what the world of EVs is like. There were cars launched, like the all-electric hypercar, the Automobili Pininfarina Battista and put up for display and other cars, like the safety vehicle, which is the Porsche Tycan, a hybrid car, were seen doing rounds of the circuit.

## The tides have turned

In terms of the development of the cars as well, teams like Nissan told us that they are going forward with a road-to-track approach now. This means that the technology that is being packed in Formula E cars now, especially in their case, is being developed using the expertise they have building road cars. This is completely opposite of what used to be the case or is the case in some classes of racing, including motorcycle racing.

What this means is that the time that technology took to make its way from Formula E cars backwards into road cars will be much less now. This approach, as it is adopted by more and more manufacturers, who are actually in the business of making cars, will make sure that it is the general populous that gets the taste of cutting-edge technology before even the drivers that are driving the ultra-fast race cars are able to get a taste of it.

Well, if our words of optimism and hope were not enough, then next, we have for you excerpts from our conversations with the technical gurus of the Maserati MSG Racing Formula E team, Nissan Formula E team, and Mahindra Racing Formula E team, where they talk about, cutting edge technology from Formula E cars, making their way into road cars.



Formula E cars racing in Hyderabad showcased the true power and potential of EVs